

1. Incident Title

Suspicious Phishing Email – Wells Fargo Impersonation

<https://mlgangao.cn/ws.html>

2. Date of Analysis

- 28/08/2025

3. Summary

A phishing email impersonating **Wells Fargo** with the subject line “Credit/Refund Has Posted” was detected. The message used a spoofed sender on the **secure.net** domain (e.g., wells Fargo@secure.net) and originated from **185.47.66.148** with no valid SPF/DMARC alignment.

The email attempted to lure the recipient into clicking a malicious link (<https://mlgangao.cn/ws.html>). Internal gateway scoring (Phish/Spam Score = 0) did not flag the message, but OSINT checks indicate the URL and related infrastructure are associated with phishing activity. This is consistent with a credential-harvesting campaign abusing a financial brand.

4. Indicators of Compromise (IoCs)

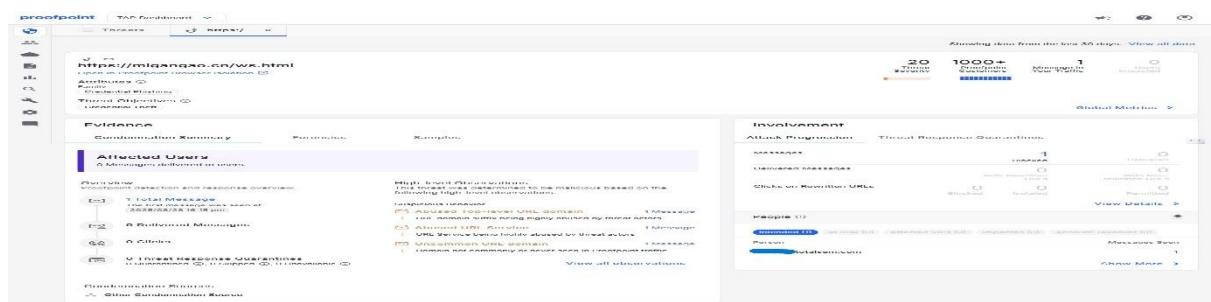
- IP Address: 185.47.66.148
- Domain: secure.net

URL: <https://mlgangao.cn/ws.html>

5. OSINT Analysis

- ProofPoint:**

Message bypassed automated filters (Phish Score/Spam Score = 0) despite containing a phishing link, indicating evasion of standard controls.



- VirusTotal:**

- The submitted URL was flagged as **malicious** by multiple vendors.



Crt.sh:

- Certificate transparency search on **secure.net** shows recently issued TLS certificates used across multiple unrelated domains, suggesting shared/abused infrastructure.

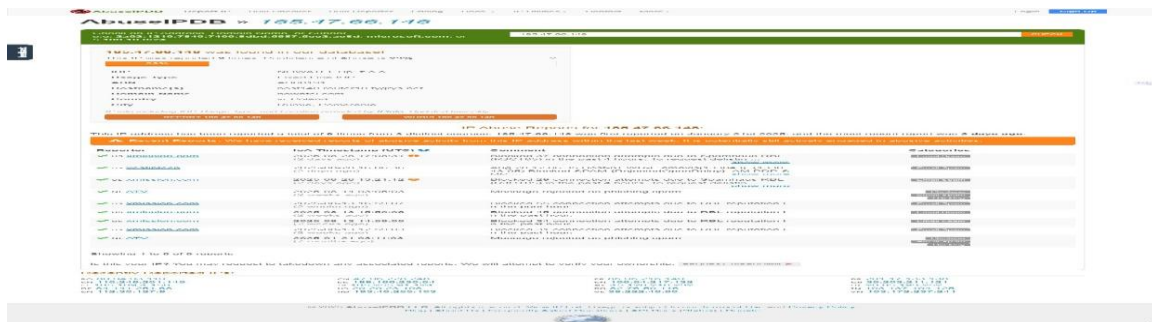
Browser tabs: ChatGPT, LinkedIn, Proton Drive, Security Operations..., Jobs, Social Media, Hands-on, Security+

Search: crt.sh?q=secure.net

Criteria: Type: Identity Match: ILIKE Search: 'secure.net'

Certificates	crt.sh ID	Logged At	Not Before	Not After	Common Name	Matching identities	Issuer Name
	20223848810	2025-08-09	2025-08-09	2026-08-09	www.com-secure.net	www.com-secure.net	C=US, ST=Arizona, L=Scottsdale, O="GoDaddy.com, Inc.", OU=http://certs.godaddy.com/repository/, CN=Go Daddy Secure Certificate Authority - G2
	19710579756	2025-07-16	2025-07-16	2026-07-16	com-secure.net	com-secure.net	C=US, ST=Arizona, L=Scottsdale, O="GoDaddy.com, Inc.", OU=http://certs.godaddy.com/repository/, CN=Go Daddy Secure Certificate Authority - G2
	19710554235	2025-07-16	2025-07-16	2026-07-16	com-secure.net	com-secure.net	C=US, ST=Arizona, L=Scottsdale, O="GoDaddy.com, Inc.", OU=http://certs.godaddy.com/repository/, CN=Go Daddy Secure Certificate Authority - G2
	14049550098	2024-08-08	2024-08-08	2025-08-08	www.com-secure.net	www.com-secure.net	C=US, ST=Arizona, L=Scottsdale, O="GoDaddy.com, Inc.", OU=http://certs.godaddy.com/repository/, CN=Go Daddy Secure Certificate Authority - G2
	13800400401	2024-07-19	2024-07-19	2025-07-19	liuna.work	com-secure.net	C=US, ST=Arizona, L=Scottsdale, O="GoDaddy.com, Inc.", OU=http://certs.godaddy.com/repository/, CN=Go Daddy Secure Certificate Authority - G2
	10094305162	2023-08-08	2023-08-08	2024-08-08	www.com-secure.net	www.com-secure.net	C=US, ST=Arizona, L=Scottsdale, O="GoDaddy.com, Inc.", OU=http://certs.godaddy.com/repository/, CN=Go Daddy Secure Certificate Authority - G2
	9846650377	2023-07-07	2023-07-07	2024-07-07	com-secure.net	com-secure.net	C=US, ST=Arizona, L=Scottsdale, O="GoDaddy.com, Inc.", OU=http://certs.godaddy.com/repository/, CN=Go Daddy Secure Certificate Authority - G2
	38101549	2016-10-01	2010-06-06	2011-06-08	myportal.secure.net	myportal.secure.net	C=US, O=Equifax, OU=Equifax Secure Certificate Authority
	37349199	2016-10-01	2010-06-05	2011-06-09	ssp.secure.net	ssp.secure.net	C=US, O=Equifax, OU=Equifax Secure Certificate Authority
	35768881	2016-09-27	2010-06-06	2011-06-09	contentlibrary.secure.net	contentlibrary.secure.net	C=US, O=Equifax, OU=Equifax Secure Certificate Authority

AbuseIPDB: IP **185.47.66.148** has a **confidence score 23/100** with several reports related to spam/phishing.



6. Findings

- ❓ The email impersonates **Wells Fargo**, but the sender domain is **secure.net**, not the legitimate **wellsfargo.com** (clear spoofing).
- ❓ **SPF/DMARC misalignment** observed in headers, consistent with spoofed delivery.
- ❓ The malicious link **mlgangao.cn/ws.html** is flagged on VirusTotal and associated with phishing activity.
- ❓ GeoIP places **185.47.66.148** in **Hong Kong**, atypical for Wells Fargo infrastructure.
- ❓ The message **evaded the email gateway** (Phish/Spam Score = 0), showing filter bypass.
- ❓ AbuseIPDB shows prior spam/phishing reports for the sending IP (score 23/100).

7. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

- Technique(s): T1566.002 **T1204.001 – User Execution**: <https://mlgangao.cn/ws.html>
- Tactic: Initial Access

8. Decision

True Positive

Justify decision: The sender domain (**secure.net**) does not match **wellsfargo.com** and mail authentication fails (SPF/DMARC). The URL is flagged as malicious, and GeoIP shows hosting in **Hong Kong**, inconsistent with Wells Fargo operations. Evidence supports a credential-phishing attempt.

9. Recommended Actions

❓ Block Indicators:

- Block **185.47.66.148** at firewall/IPS.
- Add **secure.net** patterns used in spoofing to the mail gateway blocklist (with caution to avoid collateral).

❓ Strengthen Email Security:

- Enforce **SPF, DKIM, DMARC**; quarantine look-alike domains.
- Implement brand-impersonation detection rules.

❓ Awareness & User Protection:

- Notify the recipient(s) and advise password reset if link interaction occurred.
- Remind staff to report suspicious finance-brand emails.

Monitoring & Hunting:

- Hunt in SIEM for other messages from **185.47.66.148 / secure.net**.
- Monitor for further **Wells Fargo** impersonation campaigns.

10. References / Screenshots

- Links to threat intel sources.

